European Commission

Open Source Observatory Policy Factsheet

Belgium

OSOR

1 General Information

The distribution of competences between Belgium's three-tiered government system results in a relatively decentralised approach to digital policy. Each level of government can implement its own IT and digital policies. Although the transposition of the EU Open Data Directive establishes an open-by-default policy at the federal level, implementation remains challenging. The use of open source software is developing increasingly at the local level, as demonstrated by the iMio initiative. Additionally, community-driven initiatives are well-established, with some, such as FOSDEM, having existed for many years and achieving international recognition.

2 Actors

POLICY MAKERS

The Belgian Federal Public Service for Policy and Support (FPS BOSA) is responsible for developing and monitoring digital transformation and e-government on behalf of the federal administration. It supports federal public services in improving services using innovative ICTs and contributes to the digital agenda.

STRATEGIC PLAYERS

iMio is an inter-municipal association in Wallonia and a key partner supporting local administrations in digitalising their services. All iMio services are based on the principles of open source software, open data, and open standards. Almost all of Walloon municipalities are part of iMio.

3 Policy and Legal Framework

OPEN DATA AND REUSE OF PUBLIC SECTOR INFORMATION LAW, 2016

This transposition of the EU Open Data Directive at the federal level recognises code developed by and for the federal public administration as an administrative document and mandates its transparency. Thus, it establishes an openness-by-default policy.

DIGITAL WALLONIA, 2025

Digital Wallonia is the regional government's digital strategy for Wallonia. It provides a framework for consistency and sustainability in digital policy. Although open source software is not explicitly mentioned, measures on open standards, interoperability and digital sovereignty align with open source principles.

2016 — 2025

4 Open Source Software Initiatives

Geeks Anonymes, 2026

The Anonymous Geeks is a series of monthly in-person conferences, focusing on open source software. The goal is to build a community and network of open source enthusiasts. Initially launched by the RISE department at the University of Liège in 2013, the conferences restarted in 2026 as part of the Open Source Academy initiative.

OpenFed, 2012

BOSA hosts and maintains over 100 Drupal websites for various public administrations. Developed by BOSA, OpenFed is a tailored distribution of the Drupal content management system, providing a one-stop shop for Drupal website development, hosting, maintenance and content editor support.

Local Decisions as Linked Open Data, 2016

The Digiteam of the Flemish Agency for Home Affairs developed the programme to support local authorities in publishing decisions and documents. It provides building blocks and an online editor to link local decisions with regional decrees, publish city council decisions and enable citizens and search engines to access and reuse this information.

FOSDEM, 2000

The Free and Open Source Software Developers' European Meeting (FOSDEM) is a flagship conference within the European open source community. It is organised annually by volunteers at the Solbosch Campus of the Université Libre de Bruxelles and attracts over 8000 participants from across Europe.